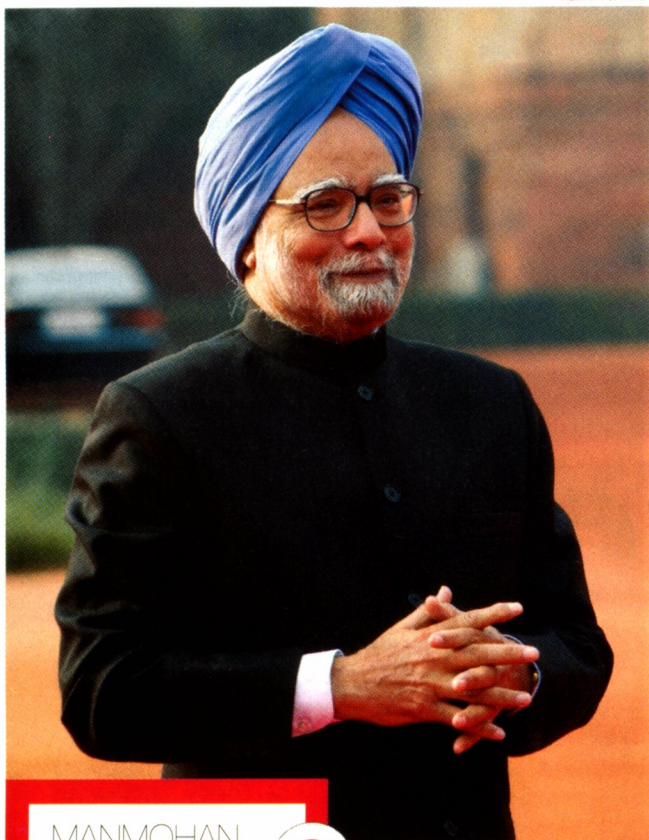


HEMANT CHAWLA



MANMOHAN
SINGH

3

76, Prime Minister (3)

Second to One

Because he believed in the Indo-US nuclear deal and staked his Government on it, winning the trust vote.

Becausethe professorial economist turned out to be the most pragmatic politician of all, wooing persona non grata Amar Singh to support the UPA after the Left withdrew support over the nuclear deal.

Becausewhile the rest of the Congress wants Rahul Gandhi to be the prime minister, Rahul wants Manmohan.

the big loss The only prime minister who watched the Republic Day parade on television.

smart move Inviting Samajwadi Party leader Amar Singh to the UPA anniversary dinner in May 2008, three months before the Left walked out.

not so smart move Hugging US President George W. Bush and telling him "India loves you".

leisure time Reading *Imagining India* by Nandan Nilekani and *The Post-American World* by Fareed Zakaria. Listening to Mirza Ghalib.

The Right Choice

Because he controls nine NDA chief ministers and six other allies.

Becausehe is the NDA's prime ministerial candidate and the RSS that once forced him to step down, now consults him routinely.

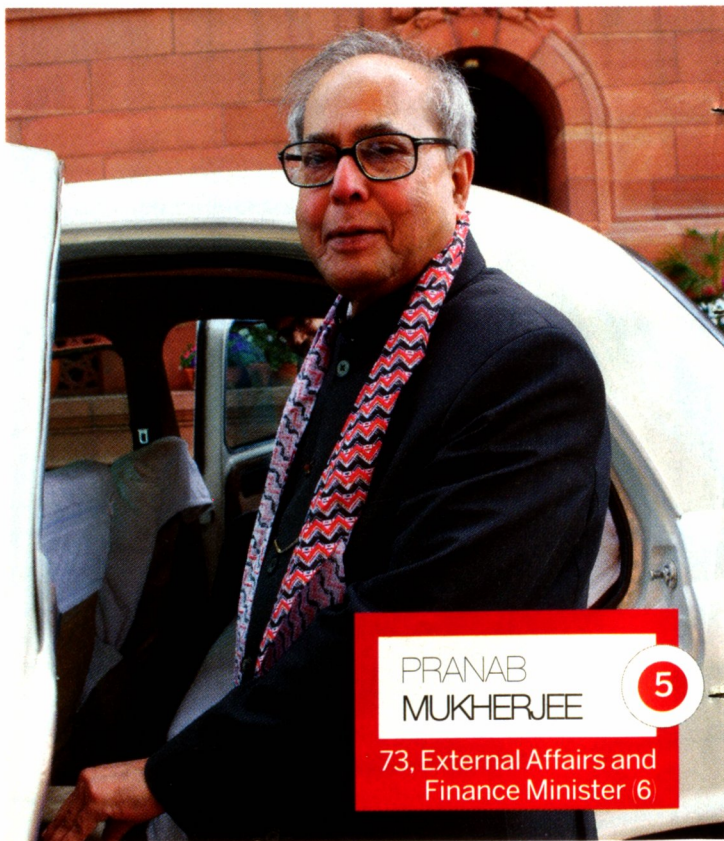
Becausewhen he calls a meeting to discuss the economy, all corporate honchos, from Mukesh and Anil Ambani to Ratan Tata, attend.

the smart acquisition A personality cult marketed by a state-of-the-art website.

enjoyed reading *The Secret* by Rhonda Byrne. The book says that if you desire or fear something intensely, it comes true.

did you know He never carries money. Once on a train as home minister, he sent back a tea vendor because he had no cash to pay for it.

the muscle flexing Picked up dumbbells while inaugurating a gym in Ahmedabad.



PRANAB
MUKHERJEE

5

73, External Affairs and
Finance Minister 6

SIPRA DAS